

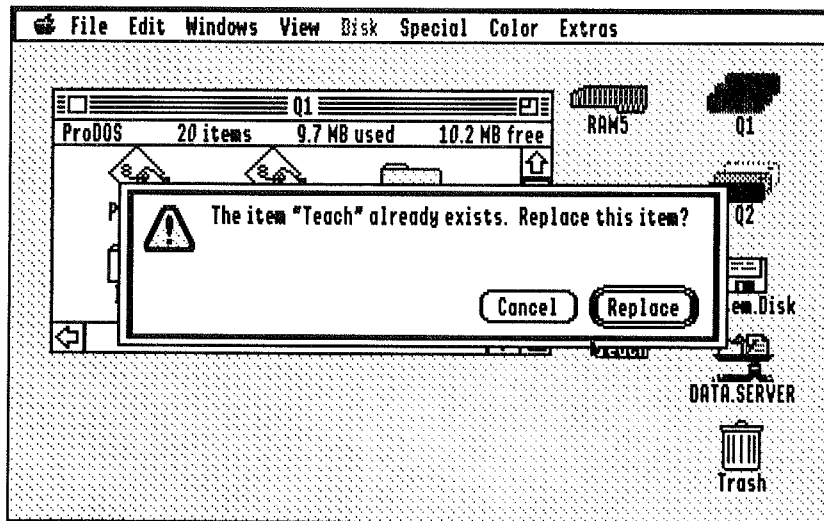


Figure 5E—Sample Alert (from Finder)

The alert window contains three important elements. First, there's an icon, which indicates what level of alert you're looking at (Figure 5F). The three alerts you'll encounter most often are:

- *Note alert.* The little talking guy with the flat face serves to tell us that the computer is just telling us something that it thinks we should be aware of. We don't necessarily need to take any action, just acknowledge that the computer's message is heard and understood. For example, when you shut down the computer using the Finder's "Shut Down" option (on the Special menu), you get a Note alert that tells you it's OK to turn the computer off.
- *Caution alert.* This is the type of alert we've encountered in Figure 5E. It indicates that there is a possibility of accidentally erasing something you didn't mean to erase (or otherwise messing something up), so the computer has decided to ask you to make sure you really want to do what you said you wanted to do.
- *Stop alert.* With its distinctive red icon and white hand, the Stop alert is the computer's way of saying "You can't do that." For example, if you try to remove a file that's in use by the System software, a Stop alert says "This operation could not be completed because a file on the disk is open." Stop alerts should be considered error messages.



Figure 5F—Alert icons